Experiment 11

Designing Pages and Navigation for a Multi-Page Business Application in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To design a clear multi-page business application in Zoho Creator with navigation that helps users complete tasks efficiently.

2. Objectives

- Identify the main user roles and tasks in a business application.
- Create pages or navigation elements appropriate to the selected application.
- Organize forms, reports, and dashboards into a logical user journey.
- Test navigation and access permissions from a user perspective.

3. Requirements

A Zoho Creator application with sample forms and reports, or access to a trial environment.

4. Theory

Page design determines how information and actions are presented to users. Navigation should reflect common tasks and use consistent labels, grouping, and visual hierarchy. A business application might include a home dashboard, a submission form, a record list, and a help or information page. Role-based access ensures users see only the functions and data they need. A well-designed interface reduces unnecessary clicks, avoids duplicated navigation, and makes the current status of a task easy to understand.

5. Procedure

1. Choose a use case and list the main user roles and tasks.
2. Sketch a simple site map showing the home page and supporting pages.
3. Create or configure pages in Zoho Creator using available page-building components.
4. Add links or navigation actions to the form, report, and dashboard.
5. Use consistent page titles and concise labels.
6. Test every navigation path and verify access using the available role or permission settings.
7. Ask a test user to complete a common task and note any confusing steps.

6. Case Study and Analysis

A department uses a request application but users struggle to find the correct form and check request status. The redesigned application presents a home page with three clear actions: Submit a Request, Track My Requests, and View Department Dashboard. Students can submit requests and review their own records, while department coordinators can access assignment and reporting functions. Navigation labels use everyday language rather than internal system terminology. The home page displays a short instruction and avoids presenting every available action at once. Testing reveals that users naturally look for request tracking immediately after submission, so a confirmation message links directly to the tracking page. The case demonstrates that page layout should follow the user's tasks rather than the platform's internal structure. Permissions must be tested separately from appearance: hiding a link alone is not a reliable security control if the underlying data remains accessible. Final testing should cover different user roles, smaller screens where relevant, and links to records that no longer exist.

7. Result / Discussion

The proposed multi-page layout groups key actions and provides a more direct path from submitting a request to tracking its status.

8. Conclusion

Effective navigation is based on user tasks, consistent terminology, and tested permissions. A simple structure can improve usability without adding unnecessary complexity.

9. Precautions / Best Practices

- Use fictional or non-sensitive test data during practice.
- Verify settings and results before using the application or configuration in a real environment.
- Record observations clearly and follow the platform's current documentation, security, and access-control guidance.